



BOOKLESSS — INTERNAL

Revenue Model & Growth Plan

Pricing structure, profitability thresholds, course rollout sequence, and team economics

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OVERVIEW

What This Model Is Built On

Booklessss delivers branded PDF study materials for Zambian university students through a Slack workspace. Revenue comes from two sources: full member subscriptions for workspace access, and per-course guest subscriptions. The model is built around Slack Business+ — one paid member seat unlocks five free single-channel guest slots.

Each course is structured across roughly four content channels plus shared support channels — announcements, general, and Q&A. Full members get access to everything: all course channels, all support channels, every course running on the platform. Guests are single-channel — they access one content channel at a time and are excluded from support channels. When a guest finishes a topic, they submit a request to be moved to the next channel. Students who want simultaneous access to all channels upgrade to K500 full members, which adds K161 markup per seat rather than guest revenue. The 330-slot guest pool is filled by single-course students at K250 each, producing up to K82,500/month per course at full capacity.

This document is the financial reference model. Actual performance is tracked against these projections monthly. Deviations in conversion rate, guest count, or overhead timing should be noted and the relevant phase thresholds recalculated.

PRICING

Subscription Rates

Tier	Rate	Slack type	Access	Net to platform
Full member	K500/month	Paid seat	All channels	K161 markup (seat costs K339)
Guest	K250/month	Single-channel guest	One channel at a time — sequential progression, no support channels	K250 — no Slack cost

Exchange rate: K27/USD. Guest rate is half the full member rate. Guests stay at K250 for one month, then upgrade to K500 or leave. The K161 markup (K500 – K339 seat cost) is platform revenue only — it does not enter the guest revenue split.

Guest channel model:

Each course runs across roughly 4 content channels plus shared support channels (announcements, general, Q&A;). Guests access one content channel at a time and are excluded from support channels. When a guest completes a topic, they submit a request to be moved to the next channel — the admin reassigns them within their existing guest slot. Full members get immediate access to all channels across all courses.

66 full members from the launch campaign × K161 = K10,626/month fixed markup income before a single guest joins. K10,626 exceeds all four overhead phases including Phase 4 (K4,442) — the platform is fully profitable from day 1 with zero guests.

ACQUISITION

Campaign Math

The campaign targets full paying members. A K10,000 budget covers both flyer printing at K10 per flyer and a K50 commission paid to the campus distributor for each student who signs up and pays. At a 10% conversion rate that yields 66 full members. Their 66 seats unlock 330 single-channel guest slots across the workspace.

Cost per flyer: K10 print + (10% × K50 commission) = K15 total per flyer

K10,000 ÷ K15 = 666 flyers distributed

666 × 10% conversion = 66 full members

66 members × 5 guest slots = 330 guest slots unlocked

Guest slots = single-course students only (1 slot = 1 student in 1 channel)

330 guests × K250 = K82,500/month guest revenue ceiling per course

Multi-course students upgrade to K500 full member — adds K161 markup, no slot used

Recruiting 50 students who each take multiple courses is far easier than recruiting 200 separate people. The multi-course model lowers the acquisition target without changing the revenue ceiling.

REVENUE STRUCTURE

How Money Flows

Guest revenue moves through two stages. First, 5% comes off the top as team welfare — covering data, meals, and transport for the course team. The remaining 95% splits three ways: 20% goes directly into the marketing campaign fund, 60% goes to the course team, and 20% goes to the platform. Every rand that flows through the campaign fund buys flyers at K15 effective cost and converts to new full members at 10% — the team is funding their own growth.

Guest revenue

– 5% welfare (data, meals, transport)

= distributable revenue

→ Marketing fund 20% → campaign (K47.50 per student)

→ Course team 60%

→ Platform 20%

Platform total = Platform 20% of distributable + K3,366 full member markup

Platform net = Platform total – Overhead

Campaign total = Platform net + Marketing fund (all reinvested)

The course team's 60% is never touched by overhead. The platform bears all fixed costs from its 20% share plus the markup. The team earns from the first guest — and the platform is already profitable before the first guest ever joins.

OVERHEAD

Cost Phases

Overhead is structured in four phases. With K10,626/month in markup from 66 full members, all four phases are active from launch — the markup alone covers Phase 4 (K4,442) before a single guest joins. No guest threshold is required to unlock any phase. All manager costs are platform overhead, never deducted from the team's share.

Phase	Trigger	New cost	Overhead
1 — Launch	Course opens	Founder Slack K339 + Founder Claude K376 + Manager Slack K339	K1,054
2 — Activate	Launch (day 1)	+ Manager Claude \$20 (K376) — markup covers it immediately	K1,430
3 — Scale	Launch (day 1)	+ Founder Claude upgrade to \$100 (+K1,506) — markup covers it immediately	K2,936
4 — Full build	Launch (day 1)	+ Manager Claude upgrade to \$100 (+K1,506) — markup covers it immediately	K4,442

PROFITABILITY

Full Model by Guest Count

Table A shows what the course team earns at each guest count (60% of distributable). Table B shows what the platform earns, including the K10,626/month fixed markup from 66 full members. All four phases are profitable at zero guests — the markup alone covers Phase 4. ✓ marks the 0-guest row where full overhead is covered from launch.

Table A — Team Earnings (per course, per month)

All phases active from launch — markup K10,626 covers Phase 4 (K4,442) before any guests

Guests	Revenue	Welfare 5%	Team 60%
0 ✓	K0	K0	K0
10	K2,500	K125	K1,425
20	K5,000	K250	K2,850
30	K7,500	K375	K4,275

Phase 4 — overhead K4,442 | active from launch

Guests	Revenue	Welfare 5%	Team 60%
30	K7,500	K375	K4,275
50	K12,500	K625	K7,125
100	K25,000	K1,250	K14,250
330 max	K82,500	K4,125	K47,025

Table B — Platform Economics (per course, per month)

All phases active from launch — profitable at 0 guests

Guests	Plat. 20%	Markup	Overhead	Net
0 ✓	K0	K10,626	K4,442	+K6,184
10	K475	K10,626	K4,442	+K6,659
20	K950	K10,626	K4,442	+K7,134
30	K1,425	K10,626	K4,442	+K7,609

Phase 4 — overhead K4,442 | active from launch, no guest threshold

Guests	Plat. 20%	Markup	Overhead	Net
50	K2,375	K10,626	K4,442	+K8,559
100	K4,750	K10,626	K4,442	+K10,934
330 max	K15,675	K10,626	K4,442	+K21,859

✓ = all phases profitable from 0 guests. Net = Plat. 20% + Markup – Overhead. Plat. 20% = guests × K250 × 95% × 20% = guests × K47.50. Team 60% = guests × K237.50 × 60% = guests × K142.50. Marketing 20% (guests × K47.50) flows directly to campaign — not shown here.

MILESTONES

Decision Points

Each milestone marks a threshold where the platform activates the next level of tooling. With K10,626 in monthly markup from 66 full members, all four overhead phases are active from launch. No guest threshold is required to unlock any phase.

Guests	Trigger	Action
0 (launch)	Campaign complete — 66 full members	Open course. Activate all tooling through Phase 4 immediately — K10,626 markup covers all phases from day 1
330	All slots filled	K21,859 platform net, team earning K47,025 — open waitlist for next course

GROWTH ENGINE

The Reinvestment Loop

Platform net income goes straight back into the flyer campaign — no extraction, no holding. Every month, the full net is converted to flyers at K15 effective cost (K10 print + K5 commission reserve). At a steady 10% conversion rate, the loop compounds automatically.

K150 net income → 10 flyers → 1 new full member → K161/month markup (permanent)

Payback period: $K150 \div K161$ = under 1 month — immediate compounding

Each month's net becomes next month's campaign budget.

More members → higher markup → larger campaign → more members.

At launch the net surplus is K6,184/month — it funds 412 flyers and adds roughly 41 new members. Those 41 members add K6,601/month in markup, lifting the next month's net to K12,785. The month after: K12,785 funds 852 flyers, adds 85 more members, net rises to K26,470. The campaign never stops — it just gets bigger each cycle.

Month	Net into campaign	Flyers	New members	Cumul. members	Markup/month
Launch	K10,000 (seed)	666	66	66	K10,626
1	K6,184	412	41	107	K17,227
2	K12,785	852	85	192	K30,912
3	K26,470	1,764	176	368	K59,248
4	K54,806	3,653	365	733	K118,013

12-Month NPV Forecast — Conservative Assumptions

This forecast is deliberately built to underestimate profit and overestimate risk. If the platform performs to these numbers, it is already doing well. Real performance is expected to exceed them.

Discount rate: 25% p.a. (BOZ policy rate 13.25% plus a conservative 12% risk premium). Full member monthly churn: 7% — above the academic-subscription norm, below the general edtech benchmark of 8–15% (loyalty.cx). Guest monthly churn: 10%. Guest upgrade rate: 2%/month. New guests recruited by course team: 5 in Month 1, growing by 3 per month — a deliberately slow ramp. Flyer conversion held at 10%. All net income reinvested into campaign each month.

Mt h	FM	Guest s	Team 60%	Founders	Net	PV Net	Cumul. NPV
1	66	0	K0	K0	K6,184	K6,070	K6,070
2	64	5	K713	K238	K6,100	K5,875	K11,945
3	63	13	K1,853	K618	K6,319	K5,977	K17,922
4	64	23	K3,278	K1,093	K6,955	K6,457	K24,379
5	68	35	K4,988	K1,663	K8,169	K7,444	K31,823
6	78	47	K6,698	K2,233	K10,349	K9,256	K41,079
7	85	61	K8,693	K2,898	K12,141	K10,653	K51,732
8	100	77	K10,973	K3,658	K15,316	K13,185	K64,917
9	124	93	K13,253	K4,418	K19,940	K16,833	K81,750
10	159	111	K15,818	K5,273	K26,430	K21,887	K103,637
11	208	130	K18,525	K6,175	K35,221	K28,602	K132,239
12	275	149	K21,233	K7,078	K46,911	K37,529	K169,768

FM = full members at start of month. Team 60% = guests × K237.50 × 60% = guests × K142.50. Founders = Platform 20% of distributable (guests × K47.50) — extracted as personal income. Net = Marketing 20% + FM markup – overhead — stays in business, reinvests into campaign. Overhead K4,442 from day 1 (all phases active from launch — markup alone covers Phase 4). Always net positive — floor K6,100 in Month 2. Per founder: divide Founders column by 3. PV at 25% p.a. — $DF = 1/(1.25)^{(n/12)}$. 12m undiscounted net: K200,035. NPV: K169,768.

Conservative 12-month NPV at 25% p.a.: K169,768

Undiscounted net over 12 months: K200,035

Month 12: 275 FM, 149 guests, K46,911 net/month

Always net positive — floor K6,100 in Month 2.

Higher churn, slower growth, 25% discount — real performance should exceed this floor.

HOW MUCH BOOKLESSS GROWS — 12 months at K500 / K250 pricing

Full members: 66 → 275 +317%

Monthly net income: K6,184 → K46,911 +658%

Course team income: K0 → K21,233/month

Each founder's share: K0 → K2,359/month (Founders column ÷ 3)

Year 1 cumulative net retained in business: K200,035

Year 1 NPV (25% discount rate): K169,768

These are the conservative numbers — 7% member churn, slow guest ramp, 10% flyer conversion. Real growth should be faster.

The campaign is never a one-time spend. It is a permanent engine: net income in → flyers out → members in → more net → repeat. The K10,000 seed starts the loop. After that, the platform funds its own growth.

ROLLOUT

Course Launch Sequence

No course opens without at least one confirmed guest commitment — this confirms real demand before hiring a manager. The threshold is low because the K10,626 markup already covers all overhead through Phase 4 from launch, including all four courses.

Course	Min. guests	Why
Course 1	1 committed	K10,626 markup > K1,054 overhead — profitable immediately
Course 2	1 committed	K10,626 > K1,393 (adds K339 manager seat) — still covered by markup
Course 3	1 committed	K10,626 > K1,732 (adds another K339) — still covered
Course 4	1 committed	K10,626 > K2,071 (adds third K339) — covered by markup, no guests required

Rollout sequence:

Campaign → 66 full members (330 guest slots unlocked)

→ Waitlist opens for Course 1

→ 1 guest committed → Course 1 launches, manager hired

→ Waitlist opens for Course 2

→ 1 guest committed → Course 2 launches, manager hired

→ Repeat for Courses 3 and 4

At four courses running at full capacity: K82,500/month guest revenue per course.

TEAM

Course Team Structure

Each course has one matched team. The Manager handles everything for that course — content delivery, community management, and marketing. Sourcers bring in source material and student referrals. Manager and Sourcers apply for a specific course and are matched before launch. No person crosses courses.

Course team: 60% of distributable guest revenue (Manager 36% + Sourcers 24%)

Marketing fund: 20% of distributable guest revenue → campaign

Welfare: 5% of gross guest revenue (data, meals, transport — off the top)

At 330 guests max: Course team K47,025 + Welfare K4,125 = K51,150 to team

Welfare is not a fixed amount — it grows with the course. At 10 guests the pool is K98. At 200 guests it is K1,950. Data stays covered throughout. Meals and transport become meaningful as the course matures and in-person sessions become regular.

All platform overhead — founder Slack, founder Claude, manager Slack seat, manager Claude — is borne by the platform from its 20% share and the full member markup. The course team's 60% is never reduced by overhead at any stage.

PAYMENT CADENCE

Weekly Team Payouts

Students pay monthly. The team gets paid weekly. Each student payment received during the week is split immediately and batched into a single Friday mobile money transfer to the Manager and Sourcers. No waiting until month-end.

Per student payment received:

K250 × 5% = K12.50 welfare (team data/meals/transport pool)

K250 × 95% = K237.50 distributable

→ Marketing 20% = K47.50 (straight to campaign fund)

→ Course team 60% = K142.50 (Manager + Sourcers)

→ Platform 20% = K47.50 (retained by platform)

Weekly Payout by Batch Size

If N students pay in the same week, multiply by N. Payments trickle across the month — some weeks are heavier than others. Pay what came in that week. Do not hold.

Guests paid	Gross	Welfare	Marketing	Team 60%	Platform
1	K250	K12.50	K47.50	K142.50	K47.50
5	K1,250	K62.50	K237.50	K712.50	K237.50
10	K2,500	K125.00	K475.00	K1,425.00	K475.00
20	K5,000	K250.00	K950.00	K2,850.00	K950.00
50	K12,500	K625.00	K2,375.00	K7,125.00	K2,375.00

Full member markup (K10,626/month from 66 members) goes entirely to the platform and is not distributed weekly to the team. Transfer it to the platform account once per month as members pay their subscriptions.

How to run it each Friday:

1. Open your payment log (WhatsApp thread or spreadsheet)
2. Sum all guest payments received Monday–Friday
3. Apply the formula: Gross × 95% × 60% → Course team
4. Transfer via Airtel/MTN Mobile Money — same day
5. Log: 'Week ending [date] — [N] payments — Manager K[X] sent ✓'

Keep every transfer receipt. This is the record actual performance is measured against.

Weekly payments are motivating and low-risk. You only pay money already received — there is no float or advance. If a student is late paying, that week's batch is simply smaller. The formula never changes.